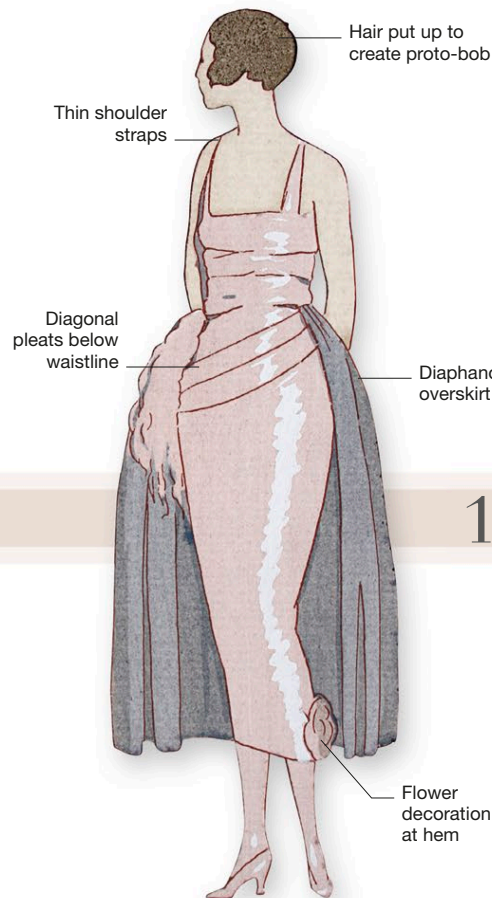




1922

For the dance This *robe à danser* by the French House of Worth combines a dress shape that foreshadows the 1950s with its wide, see-through overskirt that allows movement on the dance floor and gives the ensemble a *robe de style* air.



Lamé Fabrics using metallic yarns were popular in the 1920s. Lanvin used gold lamé for this gown decorated with three-dimensional flowers made of painted velvet. The colour red appears in the edging of the straps and hem.



Jolibois Lanvin called this gown *Prettywoods*, probably an allusion to the types of flowers embroidered on it. Soft, plush *chenille* (French for caterpillar) yarn has been used for the decoration.



1928

Feathers This evening gown by the French House of Louiseboulanger is adorned with feathers that would have emphasized the wearer's dance moves. Individual filaments of, probably, dyed ostrich plume have been knotted together to form longer strands.



Historical influence The shape of this gown by the French Boué sisters, and the flowers arranged in garlands, hark back to the 18th century. The silhouette is supported by an underslip that includes two rows of boning just below the hips.

FANS



Ostrich feathers in natural colour

The 1920s probably saw the last flowering of the fan as a fashionable evening accessory. Restaurants and nightclubs used printed paper fans for advertising, and perfume companies doused them in scent. Large fans made of ostrich feathers were particularly popular as the plumes could be dyed any colour – to match or contrast with the wearer's outfit. As here, ostrich feathers were also used in their natural colours.